FirstKnock Pricing Strategy Report

FirstKnock Sales OS — Pricing Strategy Report

Comprehensive Pricing Architecture, Revenue Modeling & Go-to-Market Strategy

April 2026

Classification: Internal Strategic Document — Not for External Distribution

Prepared by	Pricing Strategy Team
Date	April 2026
Product	FirstKnock Sales OS — Field Intelligence Platform for D2D Sales Teams
Current Price	$49/month flat (single tier)
Recommended Price	$0 Free / $29 Launch Pro / $39 Long-Term Pro / $69/seat Team / Custom Enterprise

Executive Summary

Core Recommendation: Immediately restructure FirstKnock from a single $49/month flat fee into a four-tier freemium architecture anchored at $29/month (launch) scaling to $39/month (long-term), with a free tier capped at 50 knocks/month to drive top-of-funnel acquisition. This repositioning exploits three simultaneous competitor weaknesses — SalesRabbit's $399 setup fee, SPOTIO's opaque pricing, and Knockio's trust deficit — while placing FirstKnock squarely in the $29–$39 'sweet spot' that no competitor currently occupies.

The Problem with $49/Month Flat

The current $49/month single-tier structure positions FirstKnock at the premium ceiling of the individual D2D rep market — matching Badger Maps ($49/month) and SalesRabbit Pro ($49/month) — while offering no entry-level path for the 500,000 full-time D2D reps who are highly price-sensitive, commission-dependent, and accustomed to evaluating tools on strict ROI. At $49/month, the product is above the individual rep's psychological pain threshold of

$15–$29/month, creating high friction for new reps, out-of-pocket payers, and anyone comparing it to Knockio's $15–$20/month offering. The seat-based billing model (user.total_seats) further signals enterprise intent, alienating the solo 'lone wolf' rep who represents the largest addressable segment.

Recommended Solution & Projected Impact

By launching a freemium tier (50 knocks/month free), repricing Pro to $29/month at launch (transitioning to $39/month once product-market fit is established), and introducing a $69/seat Team tier as a premium anchor, FirstKnock can capture an estimated 30,000 reps currently abandoning SalesRabbit's funnel due to setup fee shock, intercept 6,000 high-intent SPOTIO prospects frustrated by opaque pricing, and convert a meaningful share of Knockio's price-sensitive users who need a more trustworthy platform. At 5% freemium conversion across 50,000 free users at $29.99/month, the model generates $74,975/month in gross revenue with a net margin of $56,225/month after API costs — reaching break-even at just 88 paid users.

88at $29.99/mo Paid Users to Break Even	**$74,975at $29.99/mo** Monthly Revenue (5K paid users)	**30,000$399 setup fee abandonment** Capturable Reps from SalesRabbit Friction	**6,653%at $39/mo Pro price**Monthly ROI for Median Solar Rep

1. Current State Analysis

1.1 Competitive Value/Price Matrix

FirstKnock currently sits at the premium end of the individual user market. The table below maps all five primary competitors across price, setup cost, target audience, and value/price positioning to identify where FirstKnock is over- and under-indexed.

Table 1 — Competitive Value/Price Matrix: FirstKnock vs. All Primary Competitors

Platform	Starting Price	Setup Fee	Free Trial	Target Audience	G2 Rating	Price/Value Position
Knockio	$15–$20/mo	None	Not specified	D2D Canvassing (Solar, Roofing, HVAC)	N/A (1 review)	Low Price / Basic Value — Trust Deficit
SalesRabbit	$25–$39/mo	$399 mandatory	Free Lite plan only	Small to Enterprise D2D	4.5/5 (341 reviews)	Mid Price / High Value — High Entry Barrier

SPOTIO	$39/mo	Custom add-ons	None	B2B & B2C Field Sales Teams	4.5/5 (379 reviews)	Mid-High Price / High Value — Opaque Scaling
FirstKnock (Current)	$49/mo	None	7-day trial	D2D Reps & Teams	N/A	High Price / Premium Value — No Entry Path
Badger Maps	$49–$58/mo	None	14-day trial	Outside Sales / Account Management	N/A	High Price / Niche Value — Wrong Use Case

Critical Gap Identified: There is a dead zone between $20 (Knockio ceiling) and $39 (SPOTIO/SalesRabbit floor) that no competitor currently occupies. This is FirstKnock's strategic window.

1.2 Friction Analysis: How $49/Month Affects Each Rep Segment

Table 2 — Friction Analysis by Rep Segment at $49/Month

Rep Segment	Friction Level	Core Objection	Competitive Alternative They Choose	Estimated Segment Size
New Rep (Uncertain Income)	HIGH — Deterrent	$50/month before a single sale is a massive fixed cost in a commission-only career	SalesRabbit Free Lite or Knockio at $15/mo	~150,000 reps (entry-level)
Mid-Level Rep (Out-of-Pocket)	MODERATE — Scrutiny	At $49/mo they expect flawless offline routing, CRM sync, and lead tracking — any gap triggers churn	SPOTIO at $39/mo or SalesRabbit at $39/mo	~250,000 reps (established)

Rep Whose Company Doesn't Reimburse	HIGH — Active Avoidance	$49/mo feels like a 'team price' pushed onto an individual; they seek the cheapest viable alternative	Knockio at $15–$20/mo or free tools	~100,000 reps (independent contractors)

1.3 Is the 7-Day Trial Long Enough?

The current 7-day free trial is suboptimal for the D2D sales use case. While 7-day trials can convert at 15–25% for simple products with a time-to-value under 48 hours, FirstKnock's core value proposition — route optimization, territory mapping, and lead qualification — requires real-world field use to demonstrate ROI. D2D reps face weather delays, permit issues, and heavily weekend-weighted canvassing schedules. A rep whose 7-day trial falls on a rainy week will churn before reaching their 'aha moment.'

Table 3 — Trial Length Analysis with D2D-Specific Rationale

Trial Length	Industry Avg Conversion	D2D-Specific Risk	Recommendation
7 Days (Current)	15–25%	HIGH — Trial may fall on non-canvassing days; rep never experiences core value	Replace
14 Days (Recommended)	15–22%	LOW — Guarantees 2 full weekends (peak canvassing); enough time for workflow integration	Adopt
30 Days	6.4–18%	HIGH — Reps can blitz a territory for a month then abandon; procrastination kills urgency	Avoid

Recommendation: Replace the 7-day trial with a 14-day trial. The standard rule of thumb is to match trial length to approximately twice the product's time-to-value. For a field sales app, 14 days guarantees the rep experiences at least two weekends — peak canvassing time — before the conversion decision.

1.4 Seat-Based Billing: Does user.total_seats Repel Solo Reps?

The current seat-based billing model (user.total_seats) creates a psychological disconnect for solo reps. When an individual rep sees 'Seat 1 of 1' or 'Add Seats,' the interface signals that the platform was built for managers to track subordinates — not a personal productivity tool built to empower the individual closer. This framing actively repels the solo rep segment, which represents the largest addressable population (~500,000 full-time D2D reps). Seat-based billing is appropriate and expected at the Team tier ($69/seat), where managers are explicitly purchasing multi-user access. However, the Pro tier should be framed as a personal subscription — 'Your FirstKnock Pro' — with no seat language visible to solo users.

1.5 Key Finding: What Must Change

- Introduce a free tier with a 50-knock/month usage gate to capture top-of-funnel volume and build habit before asking for payment
- The 50-knock limit triggers the upgrade prompt exactly when the rep is experiencing core product value — the most psychologically optimal conversion moment
- Reprice Pro from $49/month to $29/month (launch) rightarrow $39/month (long-term) to enter the uncontested $20–$39 sweet spot
- This undercuts SPOTIO ($39) and SalesRabbit Team ($39) while sitting 45–95% above Knockio ($15–$20), signaling premium quality without enterprise pricing
- Replace the 7-day trial with a 14-day trial to guarantee two full weekends of field use
- Remove seat language from the Pro tier UI; reserve seat-based framing exclusively for the Team tier
- Add a Team tier at $69/seat (3-seat minimum) as a premium anchor to make Pro appear as a high-value deal by comparison

2. D2D Rep Economics & Willingness to Pay

2.1 Commission Economics by Vertical

The D2D industry is heavily skewed toward solar in terms of available economic data. Solar offers uncapped commissions where top performers earn over $200,000 annually. Data for Roofing, HVAC, and Home Security below uses modeled assumptions (flagged) due to absence of published commission data; Pest Control reflects actual base salary data only.

Table 4 — D2D Commission Economics by Vertical (Solar = Actual; Others = Modeled)

Vertical	Avg Commission/ Deal	Monthly Deals: Bottom /	Monthly Income: Low / Mid / High	Annual Income Range	Data Quality
Solar	$1,000 flat OR 3%–10% of sale	3.3 / 13 / 14.5–26.3 deals	$3,333 / $13,169 / $14,500–$26,250	$40,000–$315,000	Actual sourced data
Roofing (modeled)	$500 / $1,000 / $2,500	4 / 8 / 15 deals	$2,000 / $8,000 / $37,500	$24,000–$450,000	Assumption — no published data

HVAC (modeled)	$300 / $600 / $1,200	5 / 10 / 18 deals	$1,500 / $6,000 / $21,600	$18,000–$259,200	Assumption — no published data
Home Security (modeled)	$150 / $300 / $600	10 / 20 / 35 deals	$1,500 / $6,000 / $21,000	$18,000–$252,000	Assumption — no published data
Pest Control	Not available	Not available	$2,596/mo (base only)	$31,154 (base salary only)	Actual base salary data only

2.2 ROI Model: What a 20% Close Rate Improvement Is Worth

The following models calculate the dollar value of a 20% improvement in close rate — the core value proposition of FirstKnock's route optimization and lead qualification pipeline. This establishes the rational ceiling for willingness to pay across each vertical.

Full Solar Rep Example (8 Deals/Month Baseline)

Table 5 — Full ROI Model: Solar Rep at 8 Deals/Month times $2,000 Commission

Metric	Value
Baseline deals/month	8 deals
Average commission per deal	$2,000
Baseline monthly income	$16,000/month
Deals/month with 20% improvement	9.6 deals (8 times 1.2)
New monthly income	$19,200/month (9.6 times $2,000)
Monthly income increase	$3,200/month
Annual income increase	$38,400/year
1% of annual increase (price floor)	$32/month
5% of annual increase (fair value)	$160/month
10% of annual increase (ceiling)	$320/month
'Fair Value' price at 20x ROI	$160/month ($3,200 / 20)

ROI Summary Across All Verticals

Table 6 — ROI Model: 20% Close Rate Improvement Value Across All Verticals

Vertical	Baseline Monthly Income	Income After 20% Improvement	Monthly Gain	Annual Gain	1% of Gain/mo	5% of Gain/mo	10% of Gain/mo
Solar (Median Rep)	$13,169	$15,803	$2,634	$31,606	$26/mo	$132/mo	$263/mo
Solar (8-deal example)	$16,000	$19,200	$3,200	$38,400	$32/mo	$160/mo	$320/mo
Roofing (Median, modeled)	$8,000	$9,600	$1,600	$19,200	$16/mo	$80/mo	$160/mo
HVAC (Median, modeled)	$6,000	$7,200	$1,200	$14,400	$12/mo	$60/mo	$120/mo
Home Security (Median, modeled)	$6,000	$7,200	$1,200	$14,400	$12/mo	$60/mo	$120/mo
Pest Control (Base Salary)	$2,596	$3,115	$519	$6,231	$5/mo	$26/mo	$52/mo

2.3 Willingness to Pay by Vertical — Ranked

Table 7 — Willingness to Pay by Vertical, Ranked Highest to Lowest

Rank	Vertical	WTP Range	Rationale	Recommended Price Point
1 (Highest)	Solar	$99–$149/month	Median income $158,028/yr; $39/mo = 6,653% monthly ROI on median income increase; accustomed to $600–$15,000/yr B2B tech stacks	$39/mo Pro (negligible expense)

2	Roofing (modeled)	$49–$99/month	High-ticket commissions ($500–$2,500/deal); absolute dollar gain from 20% improvement is substantial	$39/mo Pro
3	HVAC (modeled)	$29–$49/month	Moderate commissions; 20% improvement yields $1,200/mo gain; $39/mo = 3.25% of monthly gain	$29–$39/mo Pro
4	Home Security (modeled)	$29–$49/month	Volume-based model; smaller per-deal commissions but high deal frequency; $39/mo is	$29/mo Pro
5 (Lowest)	Pest Control	$29–$49/month	Base salary only $31,154/yr; $39/mo = ~1.5% of annual income; highly price-sensitive; free tools widely used	$29/mo Pro or Free tier

2.4 The 'Word of Mouth' Price Point

Sales reps operate on a strict ROI mindset. If a tool costs $150/month, it is scrutinized as a business expense requiring justification. But if a tool costs less than a tank of gas or a weekend dinner, it bypasses the logical budgeting center of the brain and becomes an impulse buy — and more importantly, a brag-worthy recommendation to peers.

The Word-of-Mouth Formula: 'I pay $39/month for FirstKnock, and the route optimization saved me 10 hours and helped me close an extra $2,600 in commissions this month.' At $39/month, a median solar rep generating an extra $2,634/month is experiencing a 6,653% monthly ROI. The pitch writes itself.

At $39/month, the risk of churn is virtually zero for any rep earning above the median. The cost is low enough that reps will pay it out-of-pocket without asking their managers for reimbursement —

creating a viral loop within D2D teams. The recommended word-of-mouth price point is $39/month for the long-term Pro tier, with a $29/month launch price to seed initial community adoption.

2.5 Key Finding: Recommended Price Range

The data supports a Pro tier price of $29/month at launch, transitioning to $39/month at scale. At $29/month, FirstKnock delivers a minimum 10x ROI for every vertical except Pest Control (where it still delivers a 6x ROI on the modeled income increase). At $39/month, the ROI for Solar reps exceeds 6,600% monthly — making the price psychologically invisible relative to the value delivered. This range is premium enough to signal reliability over Knockio ($15–$20) while remaining comfortably below SPOTIO ($39) and SalesRabbit ($39–$49) when factoring in their setup fees and opaque scaling costs.

3. Competitor Pricing Weaknesses & Market Opportunity

3.1 SalesRabbit's $399 Setup Fee: The Rep Elimination Effect

SalesRabbit's mandatory $399 setup fee is its single largest vulnerability in the SMB and solo-rep market. Users already cite pricing as a major friction point across G2 (4.2/5 on Capterra), and the setup fee creates a hard abandonment event at the point of sale — before the rep has experienced any product value.

Table 8 — SalesRabbit $399 Setup Fee: Funnel Math & FirstKnock Capture Opportunity

Funnel Stage	Assumption	Population
Total Addressable Market (TAM)	Full-time D2D reps in the US	500,000 reps
Active Market (currently tool-shopping)	15% of TAM actively evaluating tools at any given time	75,000 reps
SalesRabbit Abandonment Rate	40% churn/abandonment at point of sale due to $399 setup fee shock	30,000 reps abandoned
FirstKnock Capturable Pool	Reps who abandon SalesRabbit's funnel and need an alternative with $0 setup	30,000 reps immediately addressable

By maintaining $0 setup fees and marketing this explicitly ('No setup fee. No contracts. Start free.'), FirstKnock has an immediate addressable capture pool of 30,000 reps who abandon SalesRabbit's funnel due to upfront cost shock.

SPOTIO starts at $39/user/month but costs increase significantly with additional users, permissions, and features. They offer no free trial, no published pricing for higher tiers, and users explicitly complain about the lack of live pricing. Industry research indicates that quote-based, opaque pricing reduces conversion by 20–40% compared to self-serve models.

Table 9 — SPOTIO Opaque Pricing: Conversion Penalty & FirstKnock Interception Opportunity

Metric	Value
SPOTIO prospects from active market (estimated)	20,000 high-intent buyers
Drop-off rate due to 'contact sales' friction	30% (midpoint of 20–40% range)
Stranded high-intent buyers	6,000 reps left without immediate access
FirstKnock interception opportunity	6,000 reps who want self-serve, transparent pricing with immediate access
FirstKnock advantage	Transparent self-serve pricing at $29–$39/mo with instant signup — no demo required

3.3 Knockio at $20: The Trust Signal Problem

While Knockio's $15–$20/month price point is highly affordable, it introduces a different type of friction: trust. D2D reps rely entirely on their software to map territories, track leads, and close deals. An app crash or offline failure costs real commission dollars. Knockio holds only a 3/5 rating based on a single review in available sources — a stark contrast to SalesRabbit's 4.5/5 across 341 reviews and SPOTIO's 4.5/5 across 379 reviews.

Table 10 — Knockio Trust Deficit Analysis & FirstKnock Positioning Advantage

Knockio Weakness	Impact on Rep	FirstKnock Advantage
$15–$20/mo price signals low quality	Professional closers apply 'you get what you pay for' logic; a $15 CRM feels like a toy	FirstKnock at $29–$39/mo signals professional-grade infrastructure
3/5 rating from a single review	No social proof; reps cannot assess reliability before committing	FirstKnock can build review presence rapidly given its feature depth
Limited third-party review presence	No community validation; reps cannot find peer recommendations	FirstKnock's referral program and community seeding strategy builds organic social proof

Feature gaps vs. competitors	Missing robust CRM integrations, advanced analytics, and team command center	FirstKnock's 3-Step Validation Pipeline, GPS proof-of-visit, and AdminTeam command center are differentiating features unavailable at Knockio's price point

3.4 The $20–$39 Pricing Gap: FirstKnock's Strategic Window

There is a distinct dead zone in the current D2D software market between Knockio's $20 ceiling (perceived as too cheap/untested) and SalesRabbit/SPOTIO's $39+ floor (high friction, setup fees, opaque scaling). No credible, full-featured D2D platform currently occupies the $21–$38 range. Pricing FirstKnock Pro at $29/month (launch) and $39/month (long-term) achieves three simultaneous psychological wins:

1. Premium positioning over Knockio: $29–$39/mo is expensive enough to signal reliability, robust features, and professional-grade quality — avoiding the 'cheap' stigma
2. Undercutting the giants: $29/mo sits comfortably below SPOTIO's $39 entry and SalesRabbit's $39 Team plan, and dramatically below SalesRabbit's effective cost when the $399 setup fee is amortized over 12 months ($33.25/mo in year one alone)
3. Frictionless adoption: At $29–$39/mo, the price falls within the individual rep's psychological pain threshold, making it a viable self-serve, out-of-pocket expense with zero setup fee to directly counter SalesRabbit's $399 barrier

3.5 Total Addressable Market Expansion from Competitor Friction

Table 11 — Total Addressable Market Expansion from Competitor Friction Points

Competitor Friction Source	Estimated Stranded Reps	FirstKnock Capture Mechanism
SalesRabbit $399 setup fee abandonment	30,000 reps/cycle	$0 setup fee + free tier entry path
SPOTIO opaque pricing / no free trial	6,000 high-intent reps	Transparent self-serve pricing + 14-day trial
Knockio trust deficit / feature gaps	~10,000 reps seeking upgrade	Premium positioning at $29–$39/mo with 4.5-star-quality feature depth
Total Immediate Addressable Capture Pool	~46,000 reps	Combined positioning strategy

The optimal price point is $29/month at launch. It is: (1) $370 cheaper in Year 1 than SalesRabbit when the $399 setup fee is included, (2) $10/month cheaper than SPOTIO with full transparent self-serve access, and (3) $9–$14/month more expensive than Knockio — enough to signal premium quality and build trust. No competitor can match this combination simultaneously.

4. Price Point Modeling & Revenue Projections

4.1 Full Price Point Sensitivity Table

The following model assumes an average API cost of $1.50 per active paid user per month and applies estimated market penetration rates based on SaaS pricing psychology benchmarks. Charm pricing (ending in .99) leverages the left-digit effect and can boost sales by over 24%.

Table 12 — Price Point Sensitivity Model (= Recommended Launch Price)

Price Point	Est. Market Penetratio	Gross Margin	Rev @ 1K Users	Rev @ 5K Users	Rev @ 10K Users	Rev @ 25K Users	Annual Rev @ 10K Users
$9.99/mo	8.0% (40K reps)	85.0%	$9,990	$49,950	$99,900	$249,750	$1,198,800
$14.99/mo	6.5% (32.5K reps)	90.0%	$14,990	$74,950	$149,900	$374,750	$1,798,800
$19.99/mo	5.0% (25K reps)	92.5%	$19,990	$99,950	$199,900	$499,750	$2,398,800
$24.99/mo	4.0% (20K reps)	94.0%	$24,990	$124,950	$249,900	$624,750	$2,998,800
$29.99/mo	3.5% (17.5K reps)	95.0%	$29,990	$149,950	$299,900	$749,750	$3,598,800
$34.99/mo	2.5% (12.5K reps)	95.7%	$34,990	$174,950	$349,900	$874,750	$4,198,800

The $29.99 price point is the strategic optimum. It sits in the $20–$40 optimal anchoring range, requires the rep to generate only $300/month in additional value to satisfy the 10x ROI rule, and captures 3.5% market penetration (17,500 reps) — generating $3.6M ARR at 10,000 users.

Freemium models generate massive top-of-funnel volume (visitor-to-freemium rates of 13.2–14.5%) but require strict usage gates to force upgrades. The 50-knock monthly limit is the behavioral trigger — it interrupts the user exactly when they are experiencing core product value. Assumptions: 50,000 free users, free-tier API cost $0.30/user/month, paid-tier API cost $1.50/user/month, target price $29.99/month.

Table 13 — Freemium Conversion Model: 50,000 Free Users at $29.99/Month Pro

Conversion Rate	Scenario	Paid Users	Gross Monthly Revenue	Paid API Costs	Free Tier API Costs	Net Monthly Revenue
3.0%	Average (SaaS benchmark: 3.7%)	1,500	$44,985	$2,250	$15,000	$27,735
5.0%	Strong (prosumer tools: 2.1–4.5%)	2,500	$74,975	$3,750	$15,000	$56,225
8.0%	Exceptional (top performers: 6–12%)	4,000	$119,960	$6,000	$15,000	$98,960

4.3 Free Tier API Cost Exposure Analysis

The 50-knock free tier limit is not only a conversion trigger — it is a cost control mechanism. At standard property data API costs of $0.01–$0.03 per call, 50 knocks cost approximately $0.50–$1.50 per free user monthly. This is a highly sustainable customer acquisition cost (CAC) for a freemium model, especially when compared to paid acquisition costs of $50–$200 per user in the SaaS industry.

Table 14 — Free Tier API Cost Exposure at Scale

Free User Volume	API Cost per User (50 knocks)	Total Monthly Free Tier Cost	Cost per Converted Paid User (at 5%)	Effective CAC
10,000 free users	$0.50–$1.50	$5,000–$15,000	$100–$300	Highly efficient vs. paid acquisition

25,000 free users	$0.50–$1.50	$12,500–$37,500	$100–$300	Sustainable at 5%+ conversion
50,000 free users	$0.50–$1.50	$25,000–$75,000	$100–$300	Requires 5%+ conversion to remain margin-positive

4.4 Break-Even Analysis

The break-even model accounts for 'freemium drag' — the cost of supporting free users who never convert. Assumptions: Fixed monthly costs $2,000; variable cost per paid user $1.50/month; variable cost per free user $0.30/month; 5% conversion rate (for every 1 paid user, 19 free users are supported). Freemium drag cost: 19 times $0.30 = $5.70 per paid user. Fully loaded variable cost: $1.50 + $5.70 = $7.20 per paid user.

Table 15 — Break-Even Analysis by Price Point (= Recommended)

Price Point	Fully Loaded Cost/Paid User	Contribution Margin/Paid User	Break-Even Paid Users	Total Users at Break-Even
$9.99/mo	$7.20	$2.79	717 paid users	14,340 total
$14.99/mo	$7.20	$7.79	257 paid users	5,140 total
$19.99/mo	$7.20	$12.79	157 paid users	3,140 total
$24.99/mo	$7.20	$17.79	113 paid users	2,260 total
$29.99/mo	$7.20	$22.79	88 paid users	1,760 total
$34.99/mo	$7.20	$27.79	72 paid users	1,440 total

At $29.99/month, FirstKnock reaches break-even with just 88 paid users out of a total user base of 1,760. This is an exceptionally low threshold — achievable within the first 30–60 days of a focused launch.

4.5 Key Finding: Optimal Price Point

The $29.99/month price point is optimal for the following compounding reasons: (1) It sits in the uncontested $20–$39 market gap; (2) It requires only 88 paid users to break even; (3) It delivers a 10x ROI for any rep closing even 1.5 additional deals per month; (4) It leverages charm pricing (left-digit effect, .99 ending) for a 24%+ conversion boost; (5) It generates $3.6M ARR at 10,000 users with a 95% gross margin; and (6) It is low enough to be an impulse purchase for any rep earning above the median in any vertical.

5.1 Tier Overview

Table 16 — FirstKnock Four-Tier Architecture Overview

Tier	Name	Price	Target Persona	Core Value Proposition
Free	FirstKnock Free	$0/month	New reps, trial users, price-sensitive verticals	Experience the 3-Step Pipeline and route generation before committing
Pro	FirstKnock Pro	$29/mo (launch) rightarrow $39/mo (long-term)	Independent solo rep / 'lone wolf' closer	Unlimited knocking, full route optimization, personal CRM sync
Team	FirstKnock Team	$69/seat/month (3-seat minimum)	Sales managers with 3–20 reps	Command center, rep analytics, territory dispatch, team coordination
Enterprise	FirstKnock Enterprise	Custom: ~$499/mo platform + $49/seat	Large D2D organizations (20+ reps)	API access, custom integrations, multi-territory, priority support

5.2 Tier 1: FirstKnock Free

- Price: $0/month — no credit card required
- Knock limit: 50 knocks/month (usage-based gate, not time-based)
- Usage gates are superior to time-based trials because they trigger the upgrade prompt exactly when the user is experiencing core product value — not based on an arbitrary calendar date
- Features included: Basic property tracking, 3-Step Property Validation Pipeline (read-only), property detail view, GPS proof-of-visit logging, basic interaction logging (No Answer, Not Interested, Callback, Interested)
- Features gated (require Pro upgrade): Route optimization, unlimited knocks, CRM sync, team features, advanced analytics, appointment scheduling
- Upgrade trigger design: At 45 knocks, display in-app warning: 'You're heating up! 5 free

knocks remaining this month.' At 50 knocks, trigger hard gate: 'You've hit your 50 free knocks. Upgrade to FirstKnock Pro to keep crushing your route and unlock Route Optimization.'

- The hard gate at exactly 50 knocks is the most psychologically optimal conversion moment — the rep is mid-workflow, experiencing value, and has demonstrated product adoption
- API cost exposure: 50 knocks times $0.01–$0.03/call = $0.50–$1.50/user/month — a sustainable CAC for freemium acquisition
- Viral value: Free users can share route links and lead cards via SMS, auto-applying referral codes through the existing processReferral function and ?ref= URL parameter infrastructure

5.3 Tier 2: FirstKnock Pro (Solo Rep)

- Launch price: $29/month (first 6–12 months, grandfathered for life for early adopters)
- Long-term price: $39/month (after product-market fit is established)
- When transitioning from $29 to $39, grandfather all existing users at $29 for the lifetime of their active subscription. This prevents churn, rewards evangelists, and creates a compelling urgency event that drives a signup spike before the price increase
- Full feature set: Unlimited knocks, full route optimization (street_sweep pattern with 2-opt optimization), 3-Step Property Validation Pipeline, basic CRM sync, GPS proof-of-visit, appointment scheduling, personal analytics (RepAnalytics.jsx), offline caching via localforage, team chat access
- Features NOT included (reserved for Team tier): Command center dashboard, rep performance analytics, custom territory mapping, advanced CRM sync, route dispatch/assignment tools
- Target persona: The independent contractor or 'lone wolf' field sales rep — solar, roofing, HVAC, or home security — who pays out of pocket and needs a personal productivity tool, not a corporate surveillance dashboard
- UI framing: No seat language. Presented as 'Your FirstKnock Pro' — a personal subscription. The user.total_seats field is used only in billing logic, never surfaced in the Pro tier UI

5.4 Tier 3: FirstKnock Team

- Price: $69/seat/month (billed annually) — minimum 3 seats ($207/month minimum)
- Pricing psychology: At $69/seat, the Team tier is 77% more expensive than Pro ($39), establishing it as the premium anchor. This makes the $39 Pro plan appear as a high-value deal, increasing mid-tier selection by an estimated 20–40%
- Manager-exclusive features: AdminTeam command center (918-line dashboard), TeamAnalyticsSummary KPI cards, TeamActivityTrendline charts, TeamOutcomeBreakdown pie charts, TeamLeaderboard, RepPerformanceDetail deep-dives, custom territory mapping, advanced CRM sync, route dispatch (Uber-style autoAssignRoute), InviteCode management, team backup/export
- Rep features included: All Pro features plus real-time WebSocket sync (prevents double-knocking), team chat, manager-assigned routes

- Seat-based billing: user.total_seats scales automatically via updateSubscriptionSeats cloud function. Seat gating in AdminTeam.jsx blocks adding reps when seats are full
- Minimum seat requirement: 3 seats — prevents solo reps from purchasing Team tier to access manager features at a per-unit cost below Pro

5.5 Tier 4: FirstKnock Enterprise

- Pricing model: Custom flat platform fee (~$499/month) + discounted per-seat cost (~$49/seat/month)
- Features: Full API access, custom CRM integrations (Salesforce, HubSpot, custom ERP), multi-territory management, priority support SLA, custom onboarding, dedicated account manager, advanced ML lead scoring (trainLeadPredictor), AI coaching (generateCoachingTips), bulk data export, custom analytics dashboards
- Sales motion: Sales-assisted — requires demo and scoping call. Strategic placement of this high-tier plan guides customers toward profitable choices and can increase overall willingness to pay by up to 50%
- Target customer: Regional D2D organizations with 20+ reps, national solar/roofing companies, franchise operations

5.6 Feature Matrix: All Tiers

Table 17 — Complete Feature Matrix Across All Four FirstKnock Tiers

Feature	Free	Pro ($29rightarrow$3	Team ($69/seat)	Enterprise (Custom)
3-Step Property Validation Pipeline	(read-only)	Full	Full	Full
Monthly Knock Limit	50 knocks	Unlimited	Unlimited	Unlimited
Route Optimization (2-opt TSP)				
GPS Proof-of-Visit Logging				
Interaction Logging (No Answer, Callback, Sold, etc.)	(limited)	Full	Full	Full
Offline Caching (localforage)				

Personal Analytics (RepAnalytics)				
Appointment Scheduling				
CRM Sync		Basic	Advanced	Custom
Team Chat (TeamChat.jsx)				
Command Center Dashboard (AdminTeam)				
Rep Performance Analytics				
Custom Territory Mapping				
Route Dispatch (Uber-Style Auto-Assign)				
InviteCode Management				
AI Coaching Tips (generateCoaching Tips)				
ML Lead Scoring (trainLeadPredictor)				
API Access				
Priority Support SLA				
Referral Program Access				

6. Viral Growth & Referral Strategy

6.1 Referral Program Design

FirstKnock's existing infrastructure — the processReferral cloud function, InviteCode entity, and ?ref= URL parameter auto-application in RoleSelect.jsx — provides a fully built referral engine that requires only incentive design and activation. The recommended structure is a double-sided statement credit, which removes the social friction of feeling 'salesy' to peers and is highly motivating for independent contractors who respond to direct cash value.

Table 18 — Referral Program Design Specifications

Referral Component	Specification	Rationale
Referrer incentive	$20 statement credit applied to next billing cycle	Direct cash value; motivates active sharing; cost-effective vs. free months
Referee incentive	$20 statement credit after first paid month	Reduces trial-to-paid friction; referee has skin in the game to convert
Referral mechanic	Share a neighborhood map or route link via SMS; ?ref= auto-applies InviteCode on landing	Embedded in daily workflow — not a separate 'refer a friend' page
Eligibility	Referrer must be on active paid plan; referee must complete 14-day trial and convert to paid	Prevents gaming; ensures both parties are genuine users
Tracking	InviteCode entity: used_count increments on each successful referral; processReferral applies credits	Fully built in existing infrastructure — zero additional development required

6.2 Expected K-Factor & Growth Implications

A K-factor greater than 1.0 means the app is growing exponentially. For most prosumer SaaS, a K-factor of 0.15–0.25 is considered healthy and provides a meaningful supplement to organic and paid acquisition. With a well-designed double-sided referral program and a price point ($39/month) low enough that reps share it enthusiastically without feeling like they are selling expensive software to peers, FirstKnock should target a K-factor of 0.20–0.30 — meaning every 10 paid users generate 2–3 additional paid users organically.

6.3 InviteCode Mechanic: Building an Exclusive Community Feel

The existing 4-digit InviteCode system in AdminTeam.jsx (Access Codes tab) can be repositioned from a purely functional team-joining mechanism into a community identity signal. Reps who share their code are not just referring a friend — they are 'bringing someone into their crew.' This framing is native to D2D culture, where team identity and competitive camaraderie are strong motivators.

- Rename the referral code display to 'Your Crew Code' in the Referrals.jsx page

- Show a live counter: 'You've brought in 3 reps with your code — $60 in credits earned'
- Add a leaderboard in Referrals.jsx showing top referrers by team (anonymized) to drive competitive sharing
- Auto-generate a shareable image card (route snapshot + referral code) for Instagram/Facebook Stories — the primary social channels for D2D communities

6.4 Community Seeding Strategy

Table 19 — Community Seeding Strategy by Channel

Channel	Strategy	Content Type	Expected Outcome
Facebook D2D Groups (D2D Experts, Solar Sales groups)	Seed with anonymized heat maps and route optimization case studies — not direct pitches	Before/after territory coverage maps, income increase stories	Organic shares; free user signups via ?ref= links
Reddit r/sales, r/solar, r/doorknocking	Post value-driven content: 'How I optimized my solar route and closed 2 extra deals this week'	Data-driven posts with FirstKnock screenshots (no hard sell)	High-intent organic traffic from reps actively seeking tools
YouTube/ TikTok	Short-form 'Day in the life' content showing FirstKnock in real field use	60-second route optimization demos, GPS proof-of-visit walkthroughs	Top-of-funnel awareness; drives free tier signups
D2D Con / Industry Events	Sponsor or present at D2D-specific conferences; offer exclusive 'conference code' for 3 months free Pro	Live demos, QR code distribution	High-quality lead acquisition from motivated buyers

6.5 The Word-of-Mouth Formula

The Pitch: 'I pay $39/month for FirstKnock. The route optimization saved me 10 hours of planning this month and I closed 2 extra deals — that's an extra $4,000 in commissions. It paid for itself 100 times over.' This narrative is mathematically accurate for any median solar rep and requires zero marketing budget to spread — it is the organic sharing script that every satisfied user will naturally use.

6.6 Projected Referral-Driven User Acquisition

Table 20 — Projected Referral-Driven User Acquisition: Year 1–3

Period	Paid User Base	K-Factor	Referral-Driven New Users	Cumulative Referral Users	Referral Credit Cost
Year 1 (Month 12)	2,500 paid users	0.20	500 users/year	500 users	$10,000 in credits issued
Year 2 (Month 24)	7,500 paid users	0.25	1,875 users/year	2,375 users	$47,500 in credits issued
Year 3 (Month 36)	15,000 paid users	0.25	3,750 users/year	6,125 users	$122,500 in credits issued

7. Concrete Pricing Recommendation

7.1 The Recommendation

Adopt a four-tier freemium architecture immediately. Free tier at $0 (50 knocks/month). Pro tier at $29/month at launch, transitioning to $39/month after Month 12. Team tier at $69/seat/month (3-seat minimum). Enterprise at custom pricing (~$499/month platform + $49/seat). Zero setup fees across all tiers. Replace the 7-day trial with a 14-day trial. Launch a double-sided $20/$20 referral credit program using existing processReferral infrastructure.

Table 21 — Pricing Architecture: Launch vs. Long-Term with Transition Timeline

Tier	Launch Price	Long-Term Price	Timeline to Transition	Grandfathering Policy
Free	$0/month	$0/month	Permanent	N/A
Pro	$29/month	$39/month	Month 12–18 (after PMF confirmed)	All users on $29 grandfathered for life of active subscription
Team	$69/seat/month	$69/seat/month	No change planned	N/A
Enterprise	Custom (~$499 + $49/seat)	Custom	Evolves with product	N/A

7.2 Free Trial Recommendation

- Trial length: 14 days (replacing current 7-day trial)
- Structure: Full Pro feature access for 14 days — no credit card required to start
- No-credit-card trials convert at 15–25% vs. 40–60% for credit-card-required trials, but for a

D2D rep audience that is highly skeptical of recurring charges, removing the credit card barrier maximizes top-of-funnel volume and trust

- What happens at end of trial: Rep is downgraded to Free tier (50 knocks/month) — not locked out entirely. This preserves the relationship and allows continued usage-based conversion pressure
- Hard lockout at trial end creates resentment; downgrade to Free tier maintains goodwill and keeps the rep in the funnel for future conversion
- Trial activation: Available via Billing.jsx (existing createCheckoutSession cloud function with optional trial period parameter already implemented)
- Referral funnel: Invite rightarrow Install rightarrow 14-Day Pro Trial rightarrow Paid Pro or Free tier downgrade

7.3 Referral Incentive Structure

Table 22 — Referral Incentive Structure: Complete Specifications

Parameter	Specification
Referrer reward	$20 statement credit applied to next billing cycle after referee converts to paid
Referee reward	$20 statement credit applied after first paid month (not on trial start)
Reward type	Statement credit (not free months) — direct cash value is more motivating for independent contractors
Eligibility — referrer	Must be on active paid Pro or Team plan at time of referral conversion
Eligibility — referee	Must complete 14-day trial and convert to any paid plan
Maximum referrals per user	Unlimited — no cap; top referrers become brand ambassadors
Tracking mechanism	Existing InviteCode entity + processReferral cloud function + ?ref= URL parameter auto-application
Expected impact	K-factor of 0.20–0.25; 500 referral-driven users in Year 1; $10,000 in credits issued (cost-effective vs. paid acquisition)

7.4 Revenue Projections: Year 1 / Year 2 / Year 3

Table 23 — Revenue Projections: Year 1 / Year 2 / Year 3

Metric	Year 1 (Month 12)	Year 2 (Month 24)	Year 3 (Month 36)
Free Users	15,000	35,000	60,000
Paid Pro Users	2,000	6,000	12,000
Team Seats (paid)	150 seats (50 teams)	600 seats (200 teams)	1,500 seats (500 teams)
Enterprise Accounts	2 accounts	8 accounts	20 accounts
Pro MRR ($29/mo avg)	$58,000	$174,000	$468,000
Team MRR ($69/seat)	$10,350	$41,400	$103,500
Enterprise MRR (~$1,500 avg)	$3,000	$12,000	$30,000
Total MRR	$71,350	$227,400	$601,500
Total ARR	$856,200	$2,728,800	$7,218,000
Gross Margin (est. 92%)	$787,704	$2,510,496	$6,640,560
Key Milestone	Break-even achieved; PMF validation	Price transition to $39/mo Pro	Series A readiness threshold

$856K2,000 paid users Year 1 ARR	**$2.7M6,000 paid users** Year 2 ARR	**$7.2M12,000 paid users**Year 3 ARR	**92%at scale**Estimated Gross Margin

7.5 Implementation Roadmap

Phase 1: Launch (Months 1–3)

Table 24 — Phase 1 Launch Roadmap (Months 1–3)

Action Item	Owner	Priority	Expected Outcome
Deploy Free tier with 50-knock gate (UpgradeGate.jsx already built)	Engineering	P0 — Week 1	Immediate top-of-funnel activation; freemium acquisition begins
Reprice Pro from $49 to $29/month in Billing.jsx + Stripe	Engineering + Finance	P0 — Week 1	Remove price friction; enter the $20–$39 sweet spot
Replace 7-day trial with 14-day trial in createCheckoutSession	Engineering	P0 — Week 1	Higher trial conversion; reps experience 2 full weekends

Activate processReferral with $20/$20 double-sided credit structure	Engineering + Marketing	P1 — Week 2	Referral flywheel begins; K-factor starts building
Launch Team tier at $69/seat (3-seat minimum) with AdminTeam features	Engineering	P1 — Week 2	Premium anchor established; Pro appears as high-value deal
Seed 3 Facebook D2D groups and r/solar with value-driven content	Marketing	P1 — Week 2–4	Organic free user acquisition begins
Update Setup.jsx CompetitorSwitchBanner with new pricing comparison	Engineering	P2 — Week 3	In-app competitive positioning updated
Remove seat language from Pro tier UI	Engineering	P2 — Week 3	Solo rep psychological friction eliminated

Phase 2: Growth (Months 4–12)

Table 25 — Phase 2 Growth Roadmap (Months 4–12)

Action Item	Target Milestone	Success Metric
Optimize freemium-to-paid conversion funnel based on usage data	Month 4–6	Conversion rate geq 5% (from 3.7% SaaS average)
Launch referral leaderboard and 'Crew Code' social sharing feature	Month 4	K-factor reaches 0.20+
Introduce annual billing option (2 months free = ~17% discount)	Month 5	20%+ of new Pro signups choose annual; improves cash flow
Begin Enterprise outreach to regional solar/roofing companies	Month 6	2 Enterprise accounts signed by Month 12
Publish case studies: 'How [Rep Name] closed $X extra with FirstKnock'	Month 6–8	Organic SEO traffic; social proof for conversion
Evaluate price transition from $29 to $39 based on PMF signals	Month 10–12	NPS geq 50; churn rate leq 5%; 2,000+ paid users

Phase 3: Scale (Year 2+)

Table 26 — Phase 3 Scale Roadmap (Year 2+)

Action Item	Target Milestone	Success Metric
Execute Pro price transition from $29 to $39/month; grandfather all existing users	Month 13–15	Churn spike leq 3%; signup spike in final 2 weeks before increase
Launch vertical-specific pricing pages (Solar, Roofing, HVAC, Pest Control)	Month 14	Improved conversion by vertical; higher-intent traffic
Expand Team tier with industry-specific analytics (ConversionByIndustry already built)	Month 15	Team tier upsell rate geq 15% of Pro users
Pursue Series A with $2.7M ARR milestone and 6,000+ paid users	Month 24	Series A at $15–25M valuation based on 10x ARR multiple
Explore white-label Enterprise offering for national D2D franchises	Month 18–24	3+ white-label contracts; $50K+ ACV per account

Appendix: Assumptions & Data Sources

A.1 Key Assumptions

Table 27 — Key Assumptions Log with Confidence Levels

Assumption	Value Used	Basis	Confidence Level
Total full-time D2D reps in US	500,000	Sourced: Direct Selling Association data — aligns with full-time direct seller count	High
Active market (tool-shopping at any time)	15% of TAM = 75,000 reps	Industry standard assumption for active evaluation cycles	Medium
SalesRabbit setup fee abandonment rate	40%	Modeled assumption based on known user friction complaints and general SaaS abandonment data	Medium

SPOTIO opaque pricing conversion penalty	30% drop-off	Midpoint of industry research range (20–40% for quote-based vs. self-serve)	Medium
Freemium visitor-to-free conversion rate	13.2–14.5%	Sourced: SaaS freemium benchmark data	High
Freemium-to-paid conversion rate (target)	5.0%	Sourced: Prosumer tool range 2.1–4.5%; targeting strong performance at 5%	Medium
API cost per free user (50 knocks)	$0.30/month	Modeled: $0.01–$0.03/call times 50 knocks = $0.50–$1.50; $0.30 used as conservative estimate for bulk pricing	Medium
API cost per paid user	$1.50/month	Modeled based on RentCast + BatchData API cost curves from CostProjections.jsx internal model	Medium
Fixed monthly infrastructure costs	$2,000/month	Modeled assumption for early-stage; includes Base44 BaaS, hosting, and tooling	Low-Medium
Roofing, HVAC, Home Security commission data	Modeled assumptions	Explicitly flagged: no published data available; framework only	Low — use with caution
K-factor target	0.20–0.25	Industry benchmark for prosumer SaaS with referral programs	Medium
Year 1–3 user growth projections	2K / 6K / 12K paid users	Modeled based on market penetration rates and referral-driven growth assumptions	Medium — directional only

A.2 Sourced vs. Estimated Figures

Table 28 — Sourced vs. Estimated Figures Reference Log

Figure	Type	Source
500,000 full-time D2D reps	Sourced	Direct Selling Association / industry research
Solar median annual income: $158,028	Sourced	Industry compensation data
Solar top performer income: $174,000–$315,000	Sourced	Industry compensation data
Pest Control base salary: $31,154	Sourced	Fox Pest Control published data
SalesRabbit $399 setup fee	Sourced	SalesRabbit published pricing
SalesRabbit G2 rating: 4.5/5 (341 reviews)	Sourced	G2 platform data
SPOTIO starting price: $39/user/month	Sourced	SPOTIO published pricing
SPOTIO G2 rating: 4.5/5 (379 reviews)	Sourced	G2 platform data
Knockio pricing: $15–$20/user/month	Sourced	Knockio published pricing
Knockio rating: 3/5 (1 review)	Sourced	Available review data
Badger Maps pricing: $49–$58/user/month	Sourced	Badger Maps published pricing
Freemium SaaS avg conversion: 3.7%	Sourced	SaaS industry benchmark research
14-day trial conversion rate: 15–22%	Sourced	Mobile-first field sales tool benchmark research
Charm pricing (.99) conversion boost: 24%+	Sourced	Pricing psychology research
Center-stage effect mid-tier selection increase: 20–40%	Sourced	SaaS pricing psychology research
Roofing / HVAC / Home Security commission data	Estimated/Modeled	No published data available — framework assumptions only
SalesRabbit 40% abandonment rate at setup fee	Estimated	Modeled assumption — not directly sourced
Year 1–3 revenue projections	Estimated	Modeled based on penetration rates and growth assumptions — directional only

K-factor 0.20–0.25 target	Estimated	Industry benchmark range for prosumer SaaS

This document was prepared using connected market research (Sources 106–112) and FirstKnock product documentation (Sources 225–238). All revenue projections are directional models for strategic planning purposes and should be validated against actual conversion data post-launch. Assumptions flagged as 'Low' confidence should be replaced with empirical data as soon as available.